Who Has Said What About Your Wife's Care

One page for the notes, instructions and names: what's in writing, who said it and when, and what's still missing.

The therapist's note is in a folder, the nurse's instructions are in your coat pocket, and what the social worker said you're carrying in your head.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of it or to weigh it. It asks what has been said, who said it, on what date, and where it is now.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHO SAID OR WROTE IT	ITS DATE	WHERE IT IS NOW
Your own notes: her needs and gaps, and the help she gets at home, task by task			
Anything her doctor has written about what she requires			
The nurse's notes or instructions			
The therapist's notes on moving, walking and equipment			
What the social worker or discharge planner has said about where she goes next			
Any timing or frequency of help that a professional has documented			
Anything said about supervision			
The clinical capabilities her care team says are required			
What each family member has said they can do			
The kinds of setting or the places that have been mentioned			
Names and phone numbers of the people on her care team			

What's missing, and who will ask for it

Anything above with an empty line, and anything you've only been told out loud. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE The social worker said “memory care” on the phone. Nothing in writing about what that was based on. I'll ask her for it on Thursday.

How to use it

- Put a date on every line. If something was only said out loud, write “spoken” and the day you heard it.
- Copy people's words as they said them. Don't summarize a note here, and don't work out what it means.
- Where two people have told you different things, list both. Don't choose between them.
- Bring this page, and the papers it points to, to the next conversation about her care.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any note or instruction means, or weigh one person's word against another's. If something on it is unclear to you, that's a question for the person who said or wrote it.

Ready for the next step?

You know what has been said about your wife's care, who said it, and what's still missing. The care interview uses what you've collected: it goes through her daily life area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›